Avid® EDL Manager

User's Guide



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Contents

Preface

The EDL Manager 1.9 Software Package 9
Included in This Manual 10
Symbols and Conventions 10
If You Need Help 11
Related Information 12
If You Have Documentation Comments 12

Chapter 1 Installing EDL Manager

Checking Your System 1-13
Installing the EDL Manager Software 1-14

Chapter 2 Getting Started with EDLs

Understanding EDLs 17
Offline and Online Editing 18
Creating an EDL 19
- Creating an EDL from a Bin 19
- Creating an EDL from an OMF file 21
- Creating an EDL from a Media Composer Sequence 22

Reading an Existing EDL into EDL Manager 22
Using EDL Manager from a Media Composer Product 23
Using the Source Table 24

Chapter 3 Customizing EDLs

Customizing in the Main Window 27

Selecting Video Tracks and Audio Channels 28
Selecting Specific Tracks 28
Redefining a Track 29
Combining or Isolating Tracks 30
Creating Stereo Tracks 31
Choosing Audio Channels 31
Selecting the EDL Format 32
Selecting the Sort Mode 34
Customizing Options 36
Setting Up the Master List 38
Changing the Starting Event Number 38
Choosing Reel IDs 38
Choosing a Timecode 40
Setting Up a Dupe List 41
Modifying Dupe Reel Type 42
Using the Preread Option 43
Specifying Dupe Reel Information 44
Setting Up Comments 45
Effects Info 46
Using Repair Notes 47
Setting Up Optimization 47
Optimization Considerations 49
Reloading EDLs 49
Setting Up Standards 50
Setting Up Serial Transmission 51
Updating an EDL with Changed Options 51

Chapter 4 Reading and Saving EDLs

Reading EDLs 53
Reading EDLs Saved on a Macintosh or DOS Disk 53
Reading EDLs Saved in OMF Format 54
Reading EDLs Saved in CMX or GVG (RT11) Formats 56
Saving EDLs 58

Saving EDLs to a Macintosh or DOS Disk 58
Saving EDLs in OMF 59
Saving EDLs to an RT11 Format 60
Creating a Sequence in a Media Composer Product 62

Chapter 5 Editing and Troubleshooting EDLs

Editing EDLs with a Text Editor 63
Fitting the Format to the EDL Manager 64
Changing the Header Format 65
Removing Problems Caused by Complex Sequences 65
Fixing Difficult Transitions 66
Locating Trouble Spots 67
Splicing and Dicing 67
Trying One Track at a Time 68
Avoiding Problems in EDLs 68
Simplifying Effects 68
Looking for Missing Information 68
Dealing with Corruptions 69

Appendix A Check List for Online Editing

Appendix B Creating EDLs for Film Projects

Matchback Conversion in Film-to-Video EDLs 73
Creating EDLs for a Matchbacked Sequence 74
Creating Audio-Only EDLs 75

Appendix C Transferring EDLs with Serial Transmission

Setting up Hardware Connections 77
Setting Serial Transmission Options 77
Transmitting the EDL 79

Glossary

Index

Tables

Table 3-1 Formats and Audio Channels. 31

Table 3-2 EDL Sort Modes 34

Table 3-3 Reel ID Options 39

Table 3-4 Timecode Type Options 40

Table 3-5 Dupe Reel Type Options 42

Table 3-6 Dupe Reel Options 44

Table 3-7 Comments Options 45

Table 3-8 Optimization Options 48

Table C-1 Serial Control Options 78



Preface

EDL Manager Release 1.9 is an update to EDL Manager Release 1.7. EDL Manager is compatible with the Avid® Media Composer®, Avid Film Composer®, Avid Media Station, and AudioVision® applications. Because EDL Manager can generate lists from any Open Media Framework® composition, it is compatible with a broad range of other applications, as well. It runs on any Macintosh system with sufficient memory and floating point support.

The EDL Manager 1.9 Software Package

The EDL Manager 1.9 software package includes:

- The EDL Manager 1.9 installer diskette
- *Avid EDL Manager Quick Reference*
- *Avid EDL Manager User's Guide* (this guide)
- *Avid EDL Manager 1.9 Release Notes*

Included in This Manual

The Table of Contents that precedes this preface lists all topics included in the book. They are presented with the following overall structure:

- *Installing* EDL Manager leads you through installing EDL Manager.
- *Getting Started With EDLs* helps you get oriented and gets you started with EDLs.
- The main body of the guide follows the natural flow of your work, with step-by-step procedures.
- At the back of the book is a comprehensive *Glossary*, providing cross-industry terms and definitions.
- Finally, a detailed *Index* helps you quickly locate specific topics.

Symbols and Conventions

This manual uses the following special symbols and conventions:

1. Numbered lists, when order is important.
    a. Alphabetical lists, when the order of secondary items is important.

- Bulleted lists, when the order of the items is unimportant.
    - Indented dashed lists, when the order of subtopics is unimportant.

⌘ This symbol refers to the Apple or Command key. Hold down the Command key and another key to perform the desired keyboard equivalent.

Look here in the margin for tips.

In the margin you will find tips that help you perform tasks more easily and efficiently.



A note provides important related information, reminders, recommendations, and strong suggestions.



A caution means that a specific action you take could cause harm to your computer or cause you to lose data.



A warning describes an action that could cause you physical harm. Follow the guidelines in the manual or on the unit itself when handling electrical equipment.

If You Need Help

If you're having trouble using EDL Manager, you should:

1. Retry the action, carefully following the instructions given for that task in this guide.
2. Check the documentation that came with your hardware for maintenance or hardware-related issues.
3. Check the Services & Support section of the Avid web site at http://www.avid.com for the latest FAQs, Tips & Techniques, Avid Answers, and other Avid online offerings.
4. Check the Avid Bulletin Board, "Avid Online," for information on product and user conferences. If you do not find the solution to your problem, you can exchange information with other Avid customers and Customer Support representatives.
5. Contact Avid Customer Support at 800-800-AVID (2843).

Related Information

The following documents provide more information about EDL Manager:

- The *Avid EDL Manager Quick Reference*
- The *Avid EDL Manager 1.9 Release Notes*

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CHAPTER 1

Installing EDL Manager

You can install EDL Manager on any Macintosh system running System 7.5. When you install EDL Manager software, you don't need to have Media Composer or Film Composer installed on the Macintosh, because EDL Manager is a standalone application.

Checking Your System

Before you begin the installation, check the available memory on your Macintosh system. You must have at least 9 MB of memory to run EDL Manager and to generate EDLs from simple sequences. If you have lengthy, complex sequences, you may need as much as 18 MB of memory on your Macintosh system.

EDL Manager requires software floating point unit (FPU) or a computer with a hardware floating point processor. The software FPU must be present and turned on in your Macintosh Control Panels folder.

Installing the EDL Manager Software

To install the EDL Manager software:

1. Quit any open applications.
2. Insert the Media Composer or Film Composer Installer diskette into the diskette drive.



MC 6.5 Installer

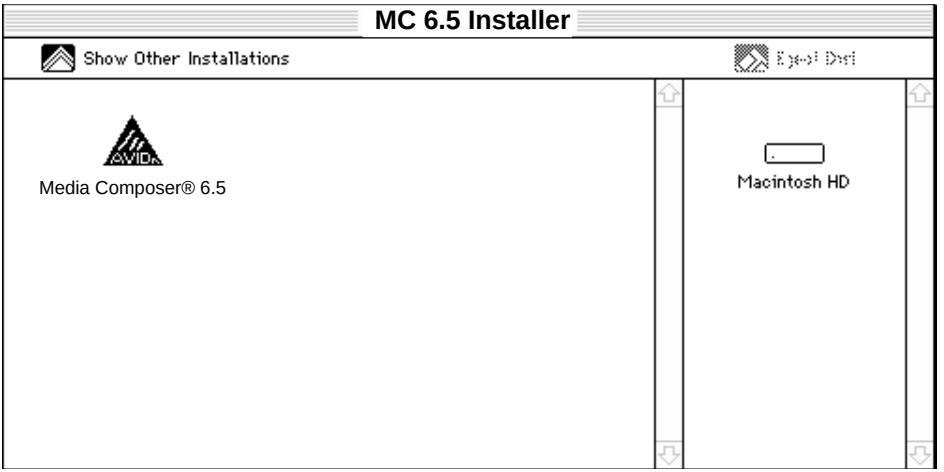
3. Double-click the 6.5 Installer icon (the screens you see may differ slightly from those in this chapter).

   A dialog box introduces the Composer 6.5 Installer.



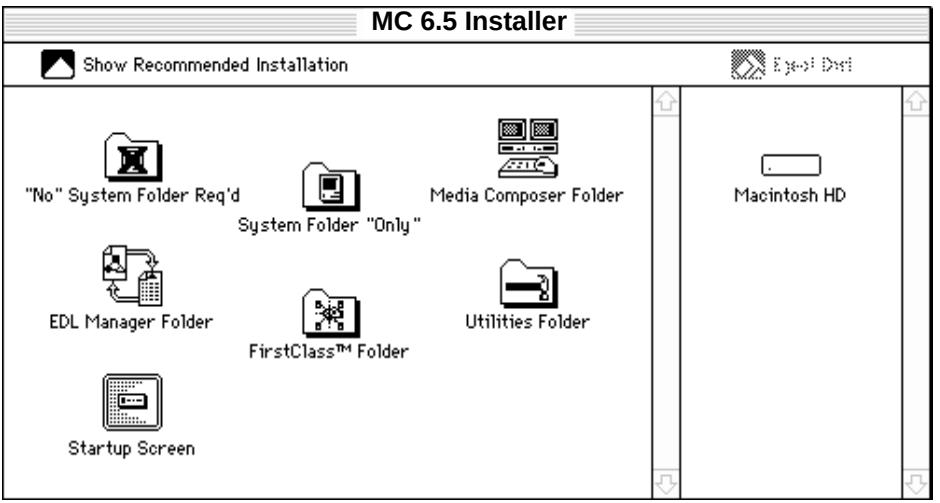
4. Click the box labeled “Click here to continue.”

   The 6.5 Installer window appears.



5. To install EDL Manager, click the Show Other Installations icon.

   A screen appears showing you other available applications.



6. Drag the EDL Manager Folder icon to the target drive to install it. In this example, the target drive is Macintosh HD.

   The installation proceeds.


EDL Mgr 1.9

After installation is complete, double-click the EDL Manager icon to launch EDL Manager.



CHAPTER 2

Getting Started with EDLs

This chapter introduces edit decision lists (EDLs) and discusses the difference between online and offline editing. It also explains how to create an EDL from a bin or an Open Media Framework Interchange® (OMFI) format, read an existing EDL into EDL Manager, and use EDL Manager from within Media Composer.

This chapter includes the following sections:

- Understanding EDLs
- Offline and Online Editing
- Creating an EDL
- Reading an Existing EDL into EDL Manager
- Using EDL Manager from a Media Composer Product
- Using the Source Table

Understanding EDLs

An *edit decision list* is a list of instructions about all the edits you will make to create a program on videotape. This list may include cuts, wipes, dissolves, fades, and black edits. EDL Manager organizes the

instructions into a series of chronological edits called *events*. Each event specifies a timecode for the source and master tapes.

You can use EDL Manager to create an EDL displaying different types of information, such as comments or patches. You can specify the different audio or video tracks in the sequence. You can also specify the assembly modes for the online edit controller.

You can use EDL Manager to generate an EDL from a sequence in a bin or an *OMF* file. OMF® is a file format for importing and exporting media; it allows you to share information with other platforms.You can also read a previously saved EDL into EDL Manager. After creating an EDL, you can save it as a text file that can be read by different edit controllers, such as Sony®, GVG, or CMX, or you can save the EDL as an OMFI composition. For instructions on saving EDLs, see **Chapter 4**.

Because EDL Manager is a standalone application, your other Avid applications need not be present when you create EDLs from sequences. You can run EDL Manager from within Media Composer and bring whatever sequence is currently in Media Composer into the EDL Manager window. After you work with the EDL in EDL Manager, you can create a sequence from the EDL in Media Composer.

Offline and Online Editing

In most cases, you generate an EDL in order to take a project from the *offline* environment, where rough editing and experimentation are less expensive, into the *online* environment where an editor using an *edit controller* can produce a finished master in less time. The EDL Manager saves EDLs in a format an editing system can use, such as GVG or CMX. You may also need to import an EDL from online back into the offline suite in order to make further changes before completing the master tape.

Traditionally, the offline environment consisted of a simplified videotape suite with less expensive machines and fewer effects capabilities. More recently, offline includes *nonlinear* systems such as Media Composer. The online environment may also include an online model of Media Composer.

In all cases, the EDL, in the form of a file generated in a readable format, is the link back and forth between the two environments.

Creating an EDL

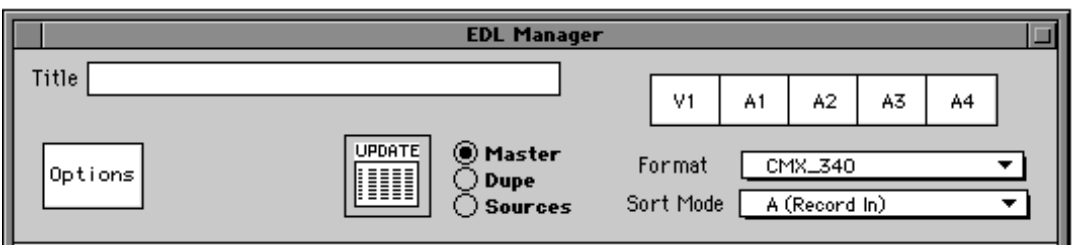
You can create an EDL from a bin, from an OMFI file, or directly from a sequence in the Record monitor of Media Composer.

Creating an EDL from a Bin

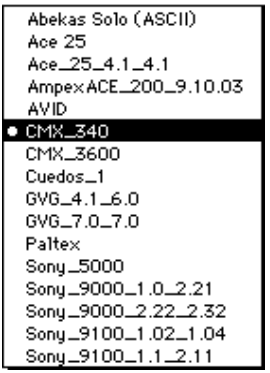
To create an EDL from a bin:

1. Launch EDL Manager.

   The EDL Manager window opens.

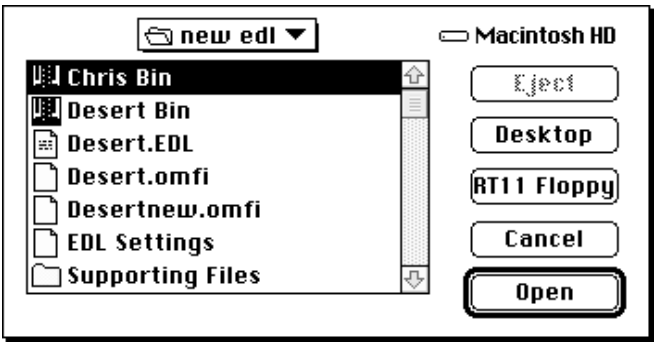


2. Choose the format appropriate for your edit controller from the Format pop-up menu in the EDL Manager window.



3. Choose Open from the File menu.

   A dialog box appears.



4. Select a bin from the dialog box.

   - If there is more than one sequence in the bin, select the sequence you want from the list and click Open.

     The information loads into the main window.

   - If there is only one sequence, click Open.

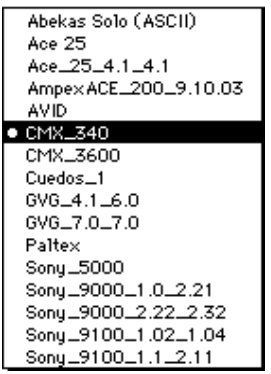
     The edit information automatically loads into the main window.

If you have problems loading a bin or EDL into the EDL Manager, choose Console from the Windows menu and look for error messages.

Creating an EDL from an OMF file

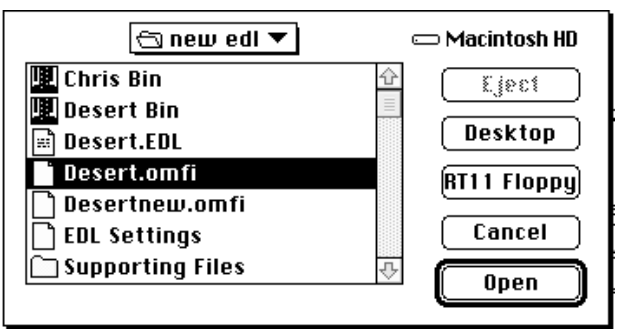
To create an EDL from an OMF file:

1. Choose the format appropriate for your edit controller from the Format pop-up menu in the EDL Manager window.



2. Choose Open from the File menu.

   A listing of files appears.



3. Select an OMF file from the file listing and click Open.

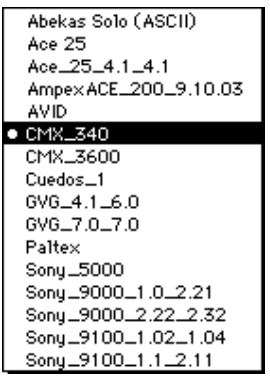
Creating an EDL from a Media Composer Sequence

You can create an EDL from a Media Composer sequence. See "Using EDL Manager from a Media Composer Product" on page 23.

Reading an Existing EDL into EDL Manager

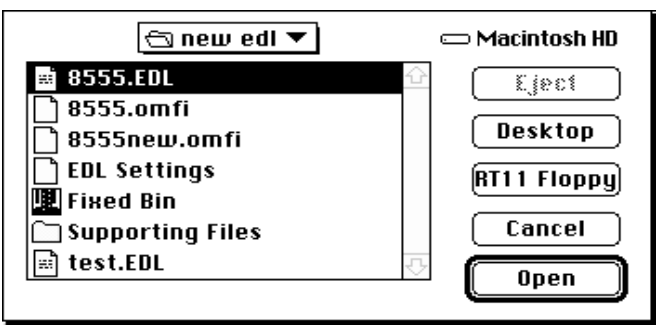
To read an existing EDL into EDL Manager:

1. Choose the format that matches the format of the EDL from the Format pop-up menu in the EDL Manager window.



2. Choose Open from the File menu.

   A listing of files appears.



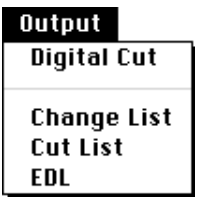
3. Select an EDL from the dialog box.

Using EDL Manager from a Media Composer Product

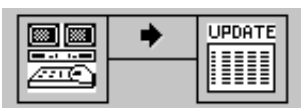
You can launch EDL Manager from an Avid Media Composer product (Media Composer, Film Composer, or Media Station) and bring EDLs from a Media Composer product into EDL Manager.

To use EDL Manager from a Media Composer product:

1. From the Output menu, choose EDL.

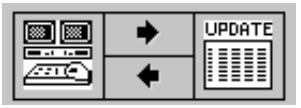


EDL Manager launches, showing the Media Composer icon connected to the Update button by a Right Arrow.



2. To create an EDL for the sequence currently active in Media Composer, do one of the following:
   - Click the Right Arrow.
   - Choose Get Seq from MC from the File menu.

The EDL appears in EDL Manager and a Left Arrow appears under the Right Arrow, indicating that you can create a Media Composer sequence from the EDL.

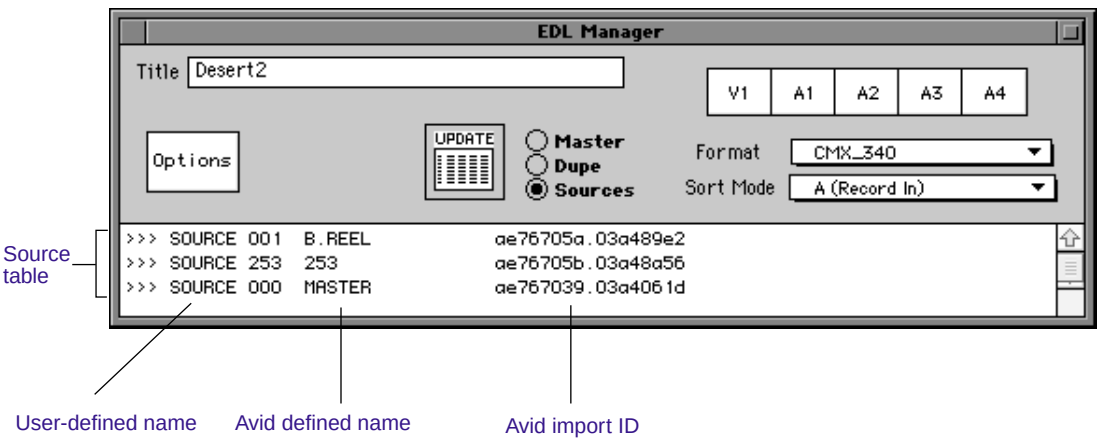


Using the Source Table

The *source table* lists all the source tapes you use to create the sequence the EDL describes. It is a useful reference when you assemble your program. Before your online session, you might want to print the source table on paper.

To view the source table, click Sources in the EDL Manager window.

The source table appears.



Each row, or source tape, in the source table contains three columns, which describe:

- The user-defined name for a source tape
- The Avid defined name for the same source tape
- The Avid *import ID*, which is the internal identification for your Avid source tape

Depending on the format of your EDL, these columns and column formats vary.

To print the source table, choose Print from the File menu.



CHAPTER 3

Customizing EDLs

This chapter describes how to customize an edit decision list (EDL) for a specific edit controller and style of online editing.

You select the options for creating the EDL in:

- The EDL Manager main window
- The EDL Manager options window

As you choose the options for your EDL, keep in mind that they might have a significant impact on the online session in terms of time and money. For example, if you finish your program in a suite with pre-read capabilities, choosing the preread option in EDL Manager can save time in dubbing sources, and save money in additional deck rental.

This chapter includes the following sections:

- **Customizing in the Main Window**
- **Customizing Options**
- **Updating an EDL with Changed Options**

Customizing in the Main Window

In the EDL Manager main window, you can set up or view the following for your EDL:

- EDL name
- Video tracks and audio channels
- Format
- Sort mode
- Master list, dupe list, or source table

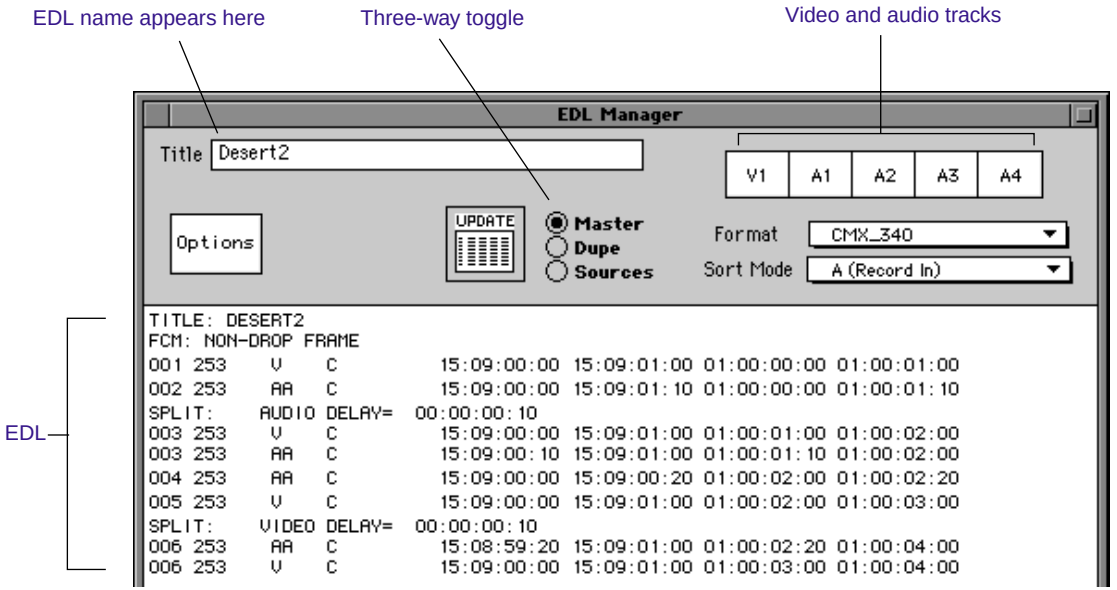


Figure 3-1 EDL Manager Main Window

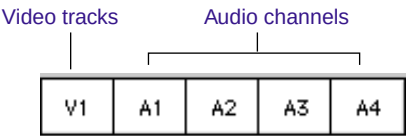
The following sections describe how to customize your EDL in the main window.

Selecting Video Tracks and Audio Channels

EDL Manager works with 24 tracks of video and up to 16 channels of audio, depending on the format you select. You can input from up to 24 tracks, but the capabilities of the edit controller determine the output tracks.

The track panel in the EDL Manager window controls the selection of video and audio tracks for the EDL. Each button in the panel represents a channel of audio or video.

The following is the default panel:



If you are creating EDLs from a simple sequence containing one video track and up to four audio channels, you can use the default arrangement of the track panel. You can reconfigure the track panel in different ways.

The following sections describe methods for selecting tracks.

Selecting Specific Tracks

If you have multiple audio and video tracks in your sequence, you can choose to include only certain tracks. To specify which tracks you want to include:

1. Click the audio or video track button in the panel.
2. Do one of the following:
   - Scroll to your choice in the track number pop-up menu.
   - Choose the hyphen (-) to turn off a track.

     The track dims when it is turned off.

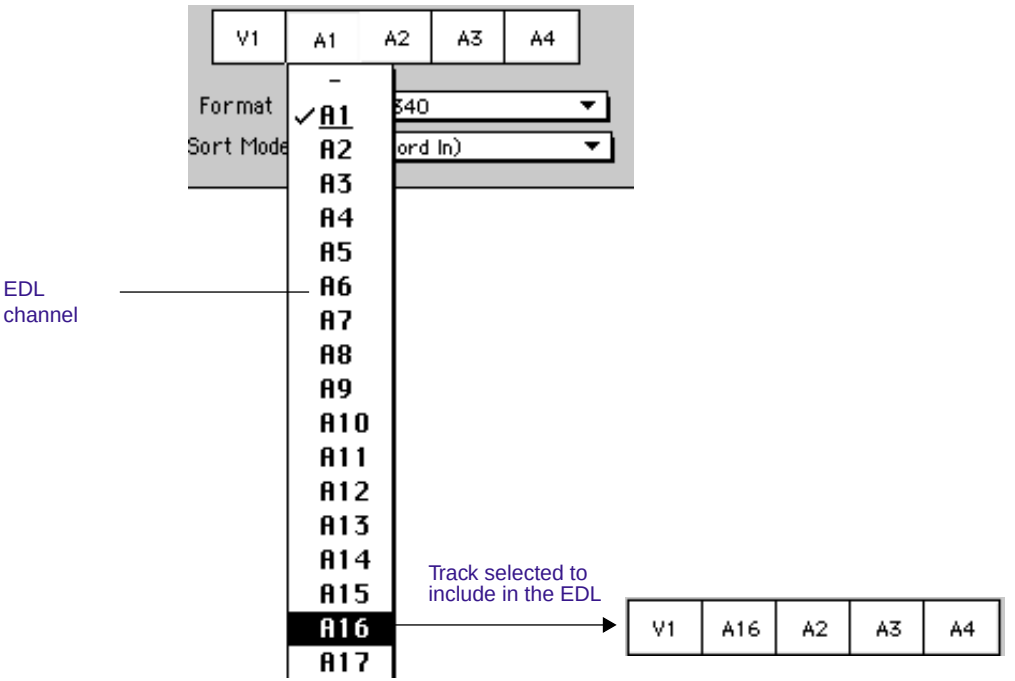
Redefining a Track

When you a select track from your sequence to include in the EDL, you can redefine the track as a different track within the EDL itself. For example, suppose you decide to move audio channel 16 in your sequence to audio channel 1 in your EDL.

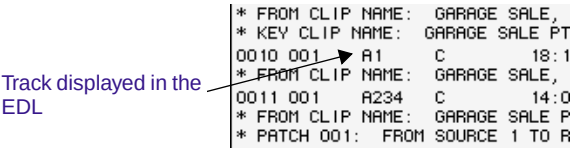
1. Choose A16 from the pop-up menu.

   The underlined number in the list of available tracks — in this case, A1 — reminds you that you are moving A16 to the EDL audio channel 1.

   The audio button displays A16, indicating your selection.



When you generate the EDL, audio channel 16 appears as A1.



Combining or Isolating Tracks

You can either combine video tracks or isolate them, depending on the complexity of your sequence.

- For simple sequences, you can combine video tracks. To do so, choose the All V (All Video) setting in the video pulldown track panel. EDL Manager combines all the video tracks in a sequence into one representative video track in the EDL.

  When you combine video tracks and the list is too complex, EDL Manager simplifies the list. To see error messages, choose Console from the Windows menu. For more information on the Console, see **"Removing Problems Caused by Complex Sequences" on page 65**.

- For complex sequences, you can isolate a video track. This is desirable if multiple video tracks are too complex to be represented in one EDL.

  For example, you might have multiple layers of keys, or a key over a superimposition (*super*) with color correction, and so on.

  Track isolation creates successive EDLs for the same sequence, each with a different video track.

To isolate a video track:

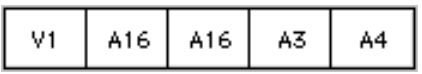
1. *Patch*, or reassign, a video track from the sequence, such as V1, in the EDL Manager track panel.
2. Save this EDL with a unique name.

Repeat steps 1 and 2 for each video track you want to isolate.

When saving successive EDLs for the same sequence, be sure to devise a system for giving each file a unique name, such as Source1.EDL, Source2.EDL, and so on.

Creating Stereo Tracks

To create stereo tracks, move the same audio channel from your sequence into two different track panels in EDL Manager. For example, if you want to create stereo tracks with A16 from your sequence, move A16 to tracks 1 and 2 in EDL Manager. The following figure shows the resulting track panel.



Choosing Audio Channels

You can include up to 16 audio channels at a time in the EDL, depending on the format you chose in the Format pop-up menu.

To choose a format:

1. Click the Format pop-up menu to open it.
2. Select a format.

Table 3-1 lists each EDL format EDL Manager provides, and the number of audio tracks (channels) each format supports.

Table 3-1 Formats and Audio Channels

Format	Number of Channels
Abekas Solo (ASCII)	2
Ace 25	2
Ace_25_4.1_4.1	2

Table 3-1 Formats and Audio Channels (Continued)

Format	Number of Channels
AmpexACE 200_9.10.03	4
Avid	16
CMX 340	2
Cuedos_1	16
GVG_4.1_6.0	4
GVG_7.0_7.0	4
Paltex	2
Sony_5000	2
Sony_9000 1.0_2.21	4
Sony_9000 2.22_2.32	4
Sony_9100 1.02_1.04	4
Sony_9100 1.1_2.11	4



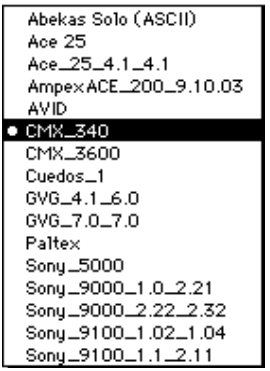
If you mix down audio channels, EDL Manager does not represent them properly in an EDL. Once audio channels are mixed down, EDL Manager does not have a source to associate them with, and therefore can't find the timecode values it needs to create a list.

Selecting the EDL Format

You need to set EDL Manager to generate an EDL in the format appropriate for your edit controller. EDL Manager supports Abekas™ Solo, Ace, Ampex®, Avid, CMX™, Cuedos, GVG, Paltex, and Sony formats.

To select a format:

1. Click the Format pop-up menu in the main window to see the specific versions.



2. Choose the format of the edit controller where you plan to take your EDL and source tapes.

   For more information on going to the online suite, see **Appendix A**.

Each of the formats may be available in different versions. For example, Avid supports GVG 4.1 and GVG 7.0 formats.

Check with your online house before you make your list. As a backup, always make a CMX_3600 list because it is the most common format. You will be prepared in case your list won't load or you are moved to another editing room at the last minute.

Selecting the Sort Mode

To minimize the amount of time the edit controller spends shuttling linear tapes, you can choose the appropriate *sort mode* in EDL Manager. The sort mode affects only the order of the events and not their content. Table 3-2 describes the different ways you can use each mode.

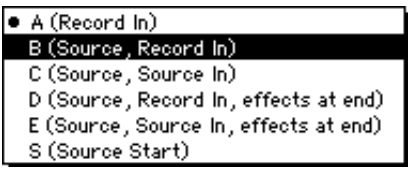
Table 3-2 EDL Sort Modes

Mode	Sorts by	Results in	Use when
A (Record In)	Record In timecode.	Sequential editing from one IN point on the record tape to the next.	You have a short show, want to generate a simple, flexible EDL, or need to make many last-minute decisions.
B (Source,Record In)	Individual source reel, then by the Record In timecode.	Checkerboard editing on the record reel, one source reel to the next.	The length of source material is roughly equivalent to the length of the finished show.
C (Source, Source In)	Individual source reel, then by the Source In timecode.	Checkerboard editing on the record reel, with sequential playback of material from each source.	The length of source material is much greater than the length of the finished show.
D (Source, Record In, effects at end)	Individual source reel, then by the Record In timecode. Sorts effects at the end.	Same as B, but with all effects saved for the end.	The length of source material is roughly equivalent to the length of the finished show, and there are many special effects.
E (Source, Source In, effects at end)	Individual source reel, then by the Source In timecode. Sorts effects at the end.	Same as C, but with all effects saved for the end.	The length of source material is much greater than the length of the finished show, and there are many special effects.
S (Source Start Only)	Source In timecode only.	Direct sequential transfer of source material, in matching order on the record reel.	Completing one-light transfers.

To choose the sort mode for your EDL:

1. Click the Sort Mode pop-up menu to open it.

   The following list appears:



2. Choose a sort mode.

Choose A mode if you are unsure about which sort mode to use.

Don't select a sort mode and then expect to change it again in the online session unless you have EDL Manager installed at the site. Some edit controllers cannot resort an EDL.

Customizing Options

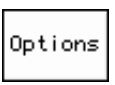
You can further customize your EDL by using the options window. You can set up:

- Master list
- Dupe list
- Comments
- Optimization
- Standards
- Serial transfer

If you don't customize your EDL, it is generated using the settings you last used.

To customize using these options:

1. Do one of the following:
   - Click the Options button.

   - Choose Options from the Edit menu.

   The options window opens in EDL Manager (see Figure 3-2).

   The options window includes an area for each customization option.

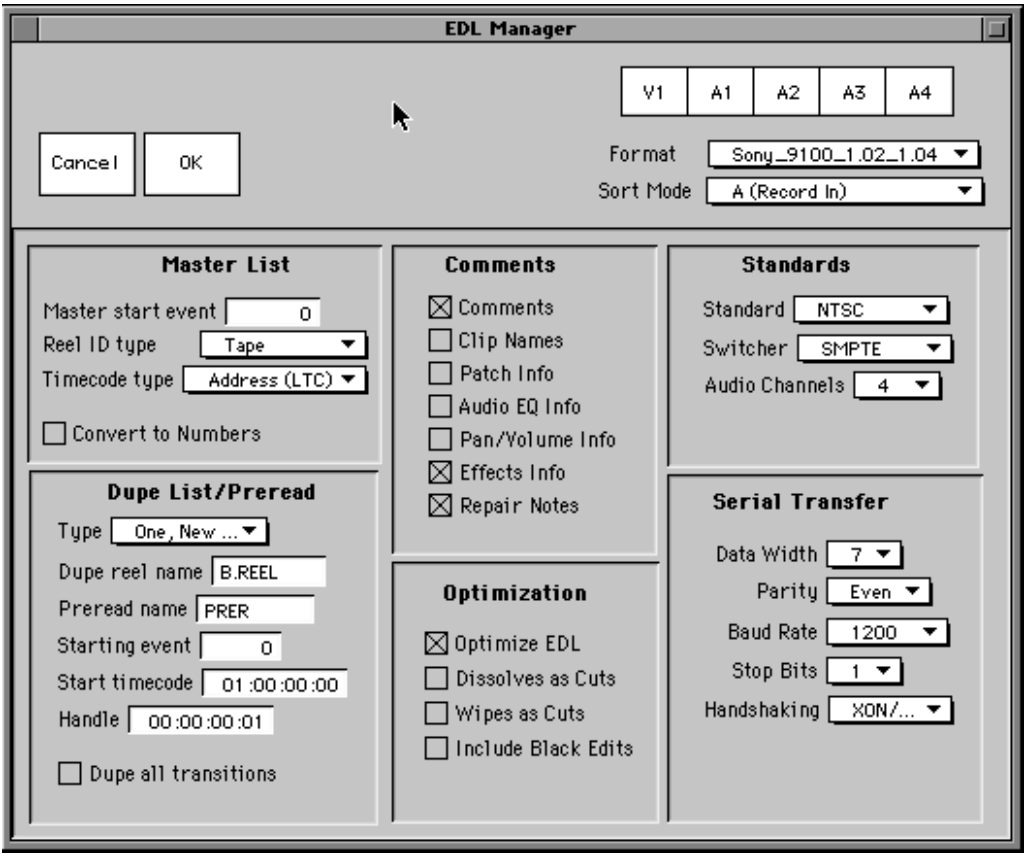


Figure 3-2 The Options Window

2. When you finish setting up options:
   - Click OK.
   - Click Cancel to return to the list with options unchanged.

If you change any options, you must update the EDL. See "Updating an EDL with Changed Options" on page 51.

Setting Up the Master List

In the *Master List* area, you can specify the master start event, reel ID type, and timecode type.

To set Master List parameters, click Options in the EDL Manager main window to display the options window.



Changing the Starting Event Number

You can change this number to the starting event of your choice; usually you won't change it.

You can change the master start event number in the *Master start event* text box.The highest number accepted by most edit controllers is 999.

Choosing Reel IDs

The *Reel ID type* option specifies the type of name used by the source in the EDL.

To choose a reel ID type:

1. The Reel ID type pop-up menu displays a list of reel IDs.



2. Choose a reel ID type, using the criteria in Table 3-3.

Table 3-3 Reel ID Options

Option	Description
Tape	Uses the reel ID from the tape source from which you digitized your video.
Sound roll	Uses the reel ID from the sound roll source, such as digital audiotape (DAT) (if you entered this information in the bin). Used for film projects.
Camera roll	Uses the reel ID from the camera source (if you entered this information in the bin). Used for film projects.
AUX (Auxiliary) Sources 1-4	Uses the reel ID from various auxiliary sources (if you entered this information in the bin).

3. Select or deselect Convert to Numbers.

   If you select Convert to Numbers, the EDL you generate always uses numbers for reel IDs, even if your edit controller uses alphanumeric tape names.



If you change reel ID, you must reload the sequence from the bin, OMFI file, or Record monitor.

Choosing a Timecode

The *Timecode type* option specifies which source's *timecode* the EDL uses. Choose a timecode from the Timecode pop-up menu using the criteria in Table 3-4, which describes the list of options and their identifying sources.



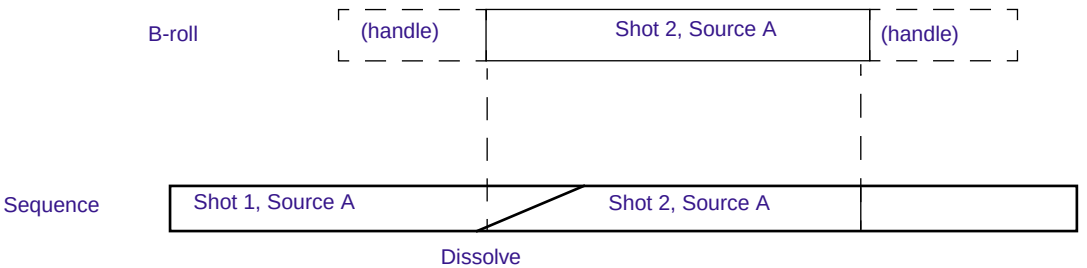
If you don't have a certain type of timecode in your bins as shown in the table, the EDL Manager can't access it.

Table 3-4 Timecode Type Options

Option	Source
Address (LTC)	Uses the longitudinal timecode of the source from which you digitized.
VITC	Uses the vertical interval timecode of the source in your bin from which you digitized.
Sound TC	Uses the timecode from the source, such as DAT or Nagra, from which you digitized. Used for film projects.
Film TC	Uses the timecode from the film source in your bin.
AUX (Auxiliary) 1-4 TC	Uses the timecode specified in the timecode column in your bin.

Setting Up a Dupe List

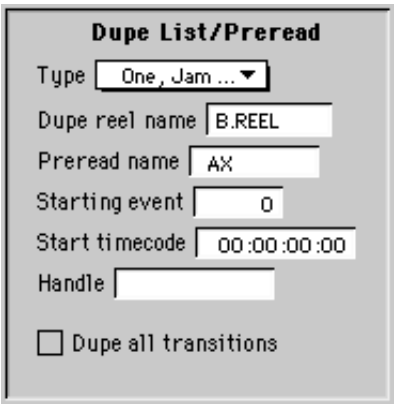
A *dupe reel* is a compilation of the duplicate clips you need to *conform* a sequence, or make the final show from your editing. If you have clips that a transition effect joins from a single tape, you need to dupe a clip so that there is another source tape to transition to and from, as one tape can't be in two places at once. The second source tape is called a *B-roll*. The following figure illustrates the use of dupe clips and a B-roll.



A *dupe list* is a list of dupe clips. The editor conforms the dupe list onto a separate master tape, which is then used as a source when editing the master list.

To create dupe reels and dupe lists:

1. Click Options in the EDL Manager main window to display the options window.
2. In the *Dupe List/Preread* area, choose settings as described in **"Modifying Dupe Reel Type" on page 42**.



Modifying Dupe Reel Type

When you create a dupe reel, you can choose a specific *Type*. Table 3-5 describes the options.

Do one of the following:

- Choose a type from the Type pop-up menu.
- Click Dupe all transitions at the bottom of the Dupe List/Preread area to force a B-roll for every transition.

Table 3-5 Dupe Reel Type Options

Option	Description
None	(Creates no dupe reel.)
One, New Timecodes	Creates one dupe reel with a start timecode you select.
One, Jam Sync	Creates one dupe reel with timecodes from the original sources.
Multiple (B-rolls)	Appends a “B” to the incoming source when transitions are made from a single source.

Table 3-5 Dupe Reel Type Options (Continued)

Option	Description
Preread	Creates no dupe list. Adapts the EDL master list to accommodate duplicate frames as preread frames when editing with digital decks.

Using the Preread Option

Preread (see Table 3-5) is an increasingly popular choice for online editing because more suites now have digital decks. Preread allows an editor to make a transition between two segments of a single source. The online session requires fewer source decks, and preread virtually eliminates the need for dupe reels, allowing online editing to move more quickly. This saves both time and resources.

Without preread, *dissolves* between two shots from a single source require three decks: two source decks and a record deck. One of the shots must be dubbed out and played from a second source deck. With preread, the third deck and the dubbing out are unnecessary.



With preread edits, the cut before the transition (sometimes called the A-side, or outgoing footage) is overrecorded. The overrecord must be equal to or greater than the duration of the transition. You specify the source name of the "to" side of a preread transition in the Preread name text box (see Table 3-6).

Table 3-6 describes the rest of the options in the Dupe List/Preread area.

Table 3-6 Dupe Reel Options

Option	Description
Dupe reel name	Name of the dupe reel.
Preread name	You can override the default name by entering a new name. The new name is an override only for the duration of the session.
Starting event	Dupe reel's starting event number.
Start timecode	Starting record timecode of the dupe reel.
Handle	Extra material you include before and after cuts on the dupe reel. To avoid handles, set this number to 00:00:00:00.

To change any of the options in Table 3-6:

1. Click the specified box.
2. Retype the name or number.

Setting Up Comments

Comments control the display of comments, general information, or modifications generated during the editing of the sequence. These comments can be helpful when conforming the program in an online suite.

To set comments in your EDL:

1. Click Options in the EDL Manager main window to display the options window.
2. From the Comments area, select the comments you want listed in your EDL, using the criteria in Table 3-7.



Table 3-7 Comments Options

Option	Description
Comments	Includes comments about events in the EDL that were added during editing.
Clip Names	Includes names associated with the source clips in Film Composer or Media Composer bins.
Patch Info	Refers to audio patching information. May aid the manual setup of cross-channel patching.

Table 3-7 Comments Options (Continued)

Option	Description
Audio EQ Info	Refers to audio equalization (EQ) information. EDL Manager generates comments containing EQ values specified for clips with audio EQ.
Pan/Volume Info	Displays pan and volume levels in each event: pan levels in percentages left and right, and volume in +/- decibels.
Effects Info	Refers to information about special effects; see explanation in "Effects Info" on page 46.
Repair Notes	Indicates modifications made to the EDL by EDL Manager; for more information see explanation in "Using Repair Notes" on page 47.



Some edit controllers might not be able to load comments successfully. Check with the online editor to make sure the edit controller can support these types of comments. Include these comments only on the printed version of the EDL.

Effects Info

If you choose *Effects Info*, EDL Manager generates a comment in the EDL that indicates the type of effect and its parameters. EDL Manager supports the following effects:

- Picture-in-Pictures
- Superimpositions
- Masks
- Film Dissolves
- Film Fades
- Fades to Color

- Fades from Color
- Keys
- Wipes

For more information on effects, see the *Avid Media Composer and Film Composer Effects Guide*.

Using Repair Notes

Repair Notes indicate changes EDL Manager makes to handle the EDL or any discrepancies EDL Manager finds in the sequence. If you select the Repair Notes comment, the EDL Manager displays changes, such as limiting the number of frames in a dissolve or invalid Source In times.

The following figure shows examples of repair notes.

Example of Repair Notes

```
0007 001    A1     C        14:13:46:22 14:14:47:21  01:01:35:05 01:02:36:04
0008 001    A23    C        18:10:12:27 18:11:13:26  01:01:35:05 01:02:36:04
0009 BLK    A1V    K B      00:00:00:00 00:00:45:08  01:02:36:04 01:03:21:12
0009 001    A1V    K O  000 14:06:56:16 14:07:41:24  00:00:00:00 00:00:00:00
* REPAIR: A SOURCE IN IS NOT VALID.
* REPAIR: A SOURCE OUT IS NOT VALID.
0010 001    A234   C        14:06:56:16 14:07:41:24  01:02:36:04 01:03:21:12
```

Setting Up Optimization

Optimization is a process that simplifies your EDL. When EDL Manager optimizes your EDL, it simplifies the text and combines or condenses events to speed up the online assembly process.

For example, if two tracks of video and one of audio share the same Record In and Record Out timecodes, and they come from the same source tape, optimization expresses them as one edit instead of three.

To optimize your EDL:

1. Click Options in the EDL Manager main window to display the options window.
2. In the Optimization area, choose options according to the criteria in Table 3-8.

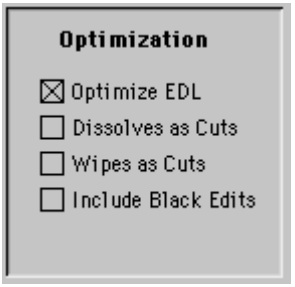


Table 3-8 Optimization Options

Option	Description
Optimize EDL	Allows optimization to occur.
Dissolves as Cuts	Changes all dissolves to cuts.
Wipes as Cuts	Changes all wipes to cuts.
Include Black Edits	Includes filler as black edits (video only). You must choose this option to have Cuts to Black appear in your EDL.

Optimization Considerations

When choosing optimization options, consider that when you choose both Dissolves as Cuts and Optimize EDL, EDL Manager combines events. This results in a loss of information, such as the fact that one event was formerly a dissolve. Turning off Optimize EDL cannot restore the two events as they were before (although you can regenerate the EDL from scratch).

The following message alerts you to this situation:

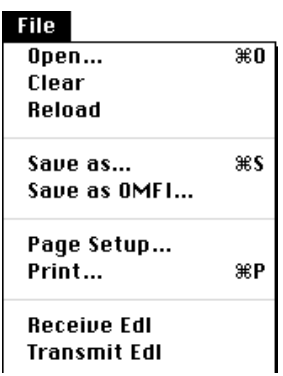
"If Dissolves as Cuts and Optimize EDL are selected, it may not be possible to recreate the Dissolves."

This does not affect the sequence in your bin, OMFI file, or Record monitor. You can always reset the dissolves by reloading your bin.

Reloading EDLs

If you optimize and then decide you don't want some or all of the changes, you can't undo the optimization. You can reload the bin or EDL to restore your original file.

To reload the current bin or EDL, choose Reload from the File menu.

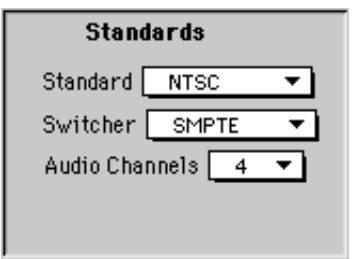


Setting Up Standards

Standards options include the broadcast standards, number of supported audio channels, and switcher settings.

To set Standards options:

1. Click Options in the EDL Manager main window to display the options window.
2. In the Standards area, select options as follows:
   a. **Standard**: Choose either the *NTSC* or one of the *PAL* settings, depending on your broadcast standard.



Select **NTSC** for video projects or for film projects in which video and audio were transferred and digitized at 30 frames per second (*fps*) using pulldown.

Select **PAL** for exclusively video projects

Select **PAL Film 1** for film projects in which video and audio were transferred and digitized together at 25 fps.

Select **PAL Film 2** for film projects in which video and audio were transferred and digitized separately at different speeds.

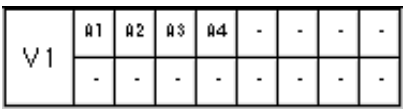


If you change this option while you are customizing your EDL, you must quit and relaunch EDL Manager for the change to take effect.

   b. **Switcher**: EDL Manager supports the *SMPTE* switcher. It also supports other types of switchers.

c. **Audio Channels**: Choose the number of audio channels. Although most edit controllers support only four tracks of audio, some edit controllers, such as Cuedos, support 16 channels. Avid systems also provide 16-track support. For a list of edit controllers and their supported channels, see **Table 3-1 on page 31**.

If you choose 16 channels, the tracks display changes to reflect the 16.



Setting Up Serial Transmission

If you are transferring the EDL to an online editor via serial transmission, use the parameters listed in **Appendix C**.

Updating an EDL with Changed Options

You can update your EDL with any of the customization options after you generate a list. Any changes you make do not take effect until you update the EDL.



To update the EDL, click the Update button in the EDL Manager main window. If you have changed an option, the Update button lights up and flashes to indicate that you should update.

If you want to change tracks in an EDL that you have already generated, clicking the Update button does not change the list. You must change the tracks and then reopen the list for these changes to take effect.



CHAPTER 4

Reading and Saving EDLs

This chapter explains how to read previously saved EDLs into the EDL Manager, and how to save new or customized EDLs.

You can read into EDL Manager EDLs that contain cuts, split edits, and dissolves, and that contain one video track and up to two channels of audio. You can save EDLs in different formats and transfer them to Media Composer.



If you have many special effects or are anticipating problems with the file format, see ***"Editing EDLs with a Text Editor" on page 63***.

This chapter includes instructions for:

- **Reading EDLs**
- **Saving EDLs**
- **Creating a Sequence in a Media Composer Product**

Reading EDLs

You can read EDLs saved in Macintosh or DOS, OMF, or CMX or GVG (RT11) formats.

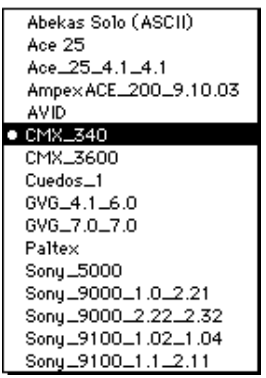
Reading EDLs Saved on a Macintosh or DOS Disk

To read an EDL saved on a Macintosh or DOS formatted disk:

1. Launch EDL Manager.

   The EDL Manager window opens.

2. Choose the file format that matches your EDL from the Format pop-up menu in the EDL Manager window.



3. Insert a diskette into the diskette drive.

4. Choose Open from the File menu.

   A dialog box appears.



5. Select the diskette that contains your EDL.
6. Select your EDL.

   The EDL appears in the EDL Manager window.

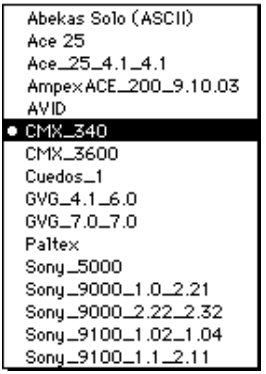
Reading EDLs Saved in OMF Format

To read an EDL saved in OMF format:

1. Launch EDL Manager.

   The EDL Manager window opens.

2. Choose the file format that matches your EDL from the Format pop-up menu in the EDL Manager window.



3. Insert a diskette into the diskette drive.
4. Choose Open from the File menu.

   A dialog box appears.



5. Select the diskette that contains your OMF EDL.
6. Select your EDL.

The EDL appears in the EDL Manager window.

Reading EDLs Saved in CMX or GVG (RT11) Formats

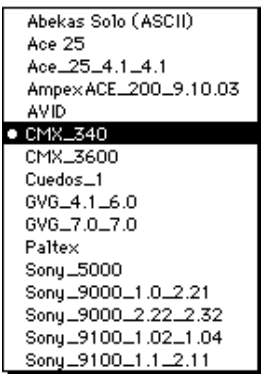
To read an EDL saved in a CMX or GVG edit controller format:

1. Launch EDL Manager.

   The EDL Manager window opens.

2. Choose the edit controller that matches your EDL from the Format pop-up menu in the EDL Manager window.

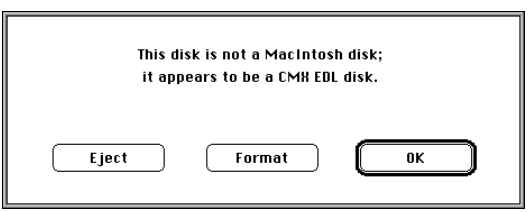
   For example, choose CMX 340 if you are reading a CMX 340 list.



3. Insert a diskette into the diskette drive.

   The white EDL Manager is in the foreground, indicating that it is active.

   A confirmation dialog box appears.



4. Click OK.

   A diskette icon appears.

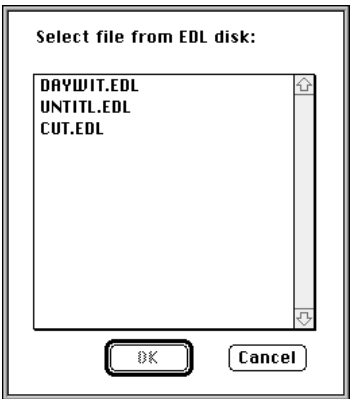
5. Choose Open from the File menu.

   A dialog box appears.



6. Choose RT11 Floppy.

   The screen displays the list of EDLs.



7. Choose the EDL you want to read into the EDL Manager.

   The EDL appears in the EDL Manager window.

Saving EDLs

You can save EDLs to diskettes formatted for Macintosh, DOS, or RT11 (CMX or GVG), or in OMF format on your hard drive.

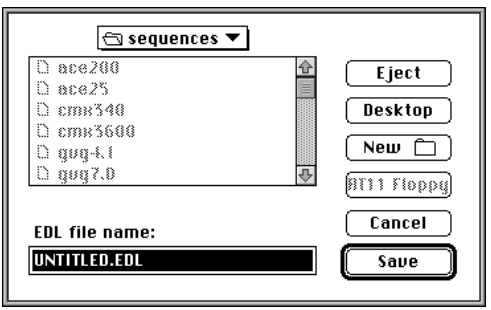
Saving EDLs to a Macintosh or DOS Disk

To save an EDL to a Macintosh- or DOS-formatted diskette:

1. Be sure the EDL Manager is in the foreground.
2. Insert a Macintosh or DOS diskette in the diskette drive.

   A diskette icon appears.
3. Choose Save As from the File menu.

   A dialog box appears.



4. From the scroll list, locate the diskette on your Macintosh desktop where you want to save the file.
5. Accept the current EDL file name or type a new name.

   The name must be eight characters or less. For DOS diskettes, it should be in all capital letters and you should also type a .EDL extension at the end of the filename. For example:

   SALLY.EDL
6. Click Save.

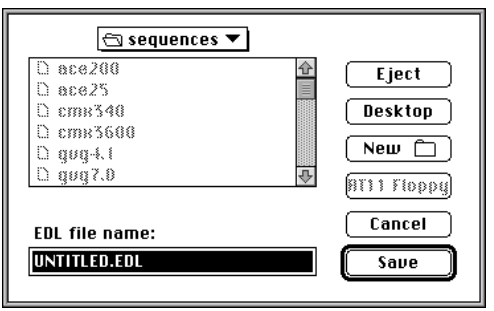
Many edit systems cannot read high-density diskettes. Use only double-density diskettes. If you are in doubt, check with the online suite or have it provide you with a formatted disk.

Saving EDLs in OMF

To save an EDL in OMF format on your hard drive:

1. Be sure the EDL Manager is in the foreground.
2. Choose Save As OMF from the File menu.

   A dialog box appears.

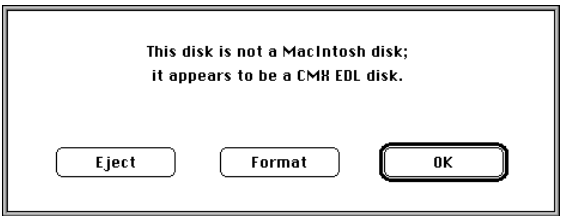


3. Accept the current EDL file name or type a new file name.
4. Choose a location where you want to save the EDL.
5. Click Save.

Saving EDLs to an RT11 Format

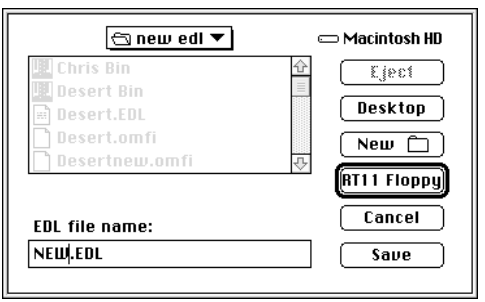
To save an EDL to a diskette formatted for RT11 (CMX or GVG):

1. Insert a CMX or GVG diskette into the diskette drive. An alert box appears.



2. Click OK.
3. Choose Save As from the File menu.

   A dialog box prompts you for the destination of the EDL file and displays the current name for the EDL file, if you have opened up an EDL from a bin.



4. Accept the current EDL file name, or type a new name.

   The name must be six characters or less in capital letters. You should also type a .EDL extension at the end of the filename. For example:

   SALLY.EDL

5. Choose RT11 Floppy.

EDL Manager saves the EDL to the CMX or GVG diskette.



Many edit systems cannot read high-density diskettes. Use only double-density diskettes. If you are in doubt, check with the online suite or have it provide you with a formatted diskette.

Because this diskette is initialized in a format other than Macintosh, it does not appear on your desktop and you cannot see its contents. The only way to verify that the EDL was actually saved onto the diskette is to go through the first few steps of importing an EDL. If the EDL appears in the Import dialog box, then you know it was saved onto the diskette.

To verify that the EDL was saved onto the diskette:

1. Select Open from the File menu.

   An alert box gives you this message: “Currently displayed EDL will be cleared.”

2. Click OK.

3. Choose RT11 Floppy.

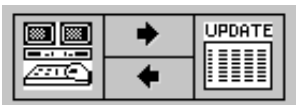
   The system shows you the contents of the RT11 diskette, allowing you to verify that your EDL was saved to the diskette.

4. Click Cancel to return to the EDL Manager.

Creating a Sequence in a Media Composer Product

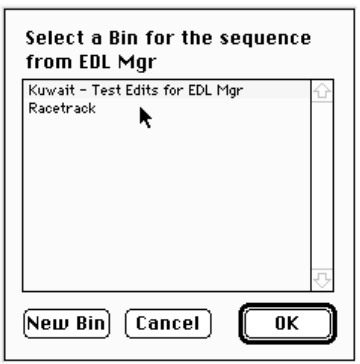
To create a sequence in a Media Composer product (Media Composer, Film Composer, or Media Station) from an EDL :

1. With Media Composer running, do one of the following:
   - Click the Left Arrow in the EDL Manager main window.



   - Choose Create MC Seq from the EDL Manager File menu.

   The Media Composer product becomes the active window, and a dialog box appears.



   The list includes only bins currently open in the Media Composer product.

2. Select an existing bin or create a new bin in which to place the EDL sequence.
3. Click OK.

   EDL Manager becomes the active window again.



CHAPTER 5

Editing and Troubleshooting EDLs

You can edit an EDL with a text editor to clean up the EDL for a successful reading. You can also troubleshoot EDLs by using techniques described in this chapter.

This chapter includes the following sections:

- Editing EDLs with a Text Editor
- Locating Trouble Spots
- Avoiding Problems in EDLs

Editing EDLs with a Text Editor

You can use a text editor to delete or change information in the EDL that may not read properly into EDL Manager. For example, you can use the Vantage text editor, which is shipped with Media Composer and Film Composer. Open Vantage from the Apple menu.



Before editing, make a copy of the EDL. Edit the copied EDL rather than the original. This way you can always revert to the original if you make errors.



When you are editing the EDL, make sure you delete only the information you want to delete; do not delete any extra characters. If you delete extra characters, you may see further errors when you try to read the EDL again.

The following sections describe possible edits you can make to clean up the EDL for successful reading. To make sure the EDL Manager can read your EDL, complete the following procedures. If the first procedure doesn't solve the problem, go on to the next.

Fitting the Format to the EDL Manager

- Check the format layout. Make sure the columns are in the right place and the characters are correct for your edit controller. To do so, choose "Show Invisible Characters" from the Vantage Layout menu, and look at the invisible characters to make sure the appropriate carriage returns are there. If you are unsure about the layout, see the edit controller documentation from the online suite.
- Check reel names and numbers to make sure they are the appropriate length for your edit controller. If you are unsure about the layout, see the edit controller documentation from the online suite.
- Delete all General Purpose Interface (GPI) triggers. They cause problems reading into EDL Manager. These triggers are labeled GPI.
- Delete any Master/Slave comments. These comments are preceded by the MS symbol. They cause problems when you are reading the EDL into the EDL Manager.
- Change the source names in the EDL from Aux and Black to an unused reel number. When you create a new EDL, this new number will represent Aux and Black. You need to do this because EDL Manager reads only numbers, not letters.

Changing the Header Format

Sometimes the EDL does not read properly because the EDL Manager does not recognize the header format. This might happen if you use an EDL not generated by an Avid system. If this is the case, you can substitute an EDL header generated by an Avid system in place of the old one.

To make sure the header format matches the EDL:

1. Delete the current header from the EDL you are trying to read.
2. Generate a list in EDL Manager that is the same format as the EDL you are trying to read.
3. Open an EDL generated by an Avid system.
4. Cut and paste the EDL headers from an EDL generated by an Avid system to the EDL you are trying to read.

Removing Problems Caused by Complex Sequences

When a sequence is too complex for the EDL Manager to describe, it generates error messages and tries to simplify the sequence. This happens most frequently when you try to generate a list for a sequence with multiple video tracks.

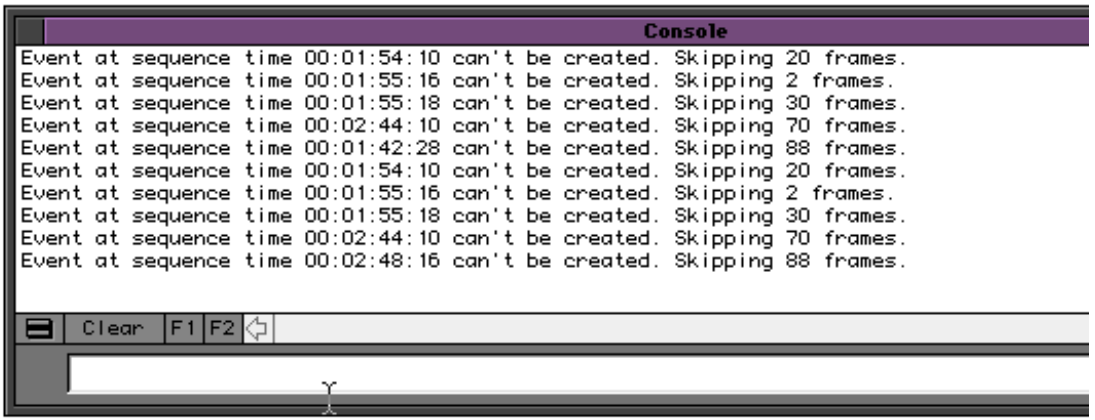
EDL Manager's attempts at simplifying complex sequences are pointed out in the repair notes and appear as comments within the list.

You can avoid having EDL Manager simplify your composition by requesting a separate list for each video track. This is known as *track isolation*. Or you can delete comments and motion effects that might be causing problems.

To see error messages, choose Console from the Windows menu.



Always check the Console after making a list. Error messages appear in the Console if certain comments or events cause problems.



The EDL Manager generally identifies motion effects by “M1,” “M2,” and so on.

Fixing Difficult Transitions

Specific transitions may cause difficulties for the EDL Manager. For example, a color effect on a resized motion-controlled clip that dissolves to an imported PICT file will overwhelm the EDL Manager’s descriptive capacities, forcing a repair note. Less obvious complexities may also trip up list generation.

You can best resolve these problems by isolating the offending transitions and simplifying or removing them.

Locating Trouble Spots

You can isolate trouble spots in several ways. They include splicing and dicing, and trying one track at a time.

Splicing and Dicing

The most effective method for finding trouble spots is *slicing and dicing* the sequence. Slicing and dicing isolates trouble spots by dividing sequences in half and testing for successful generation. If you have Avid Media Composer, you can:

1. Load the sequence into the Source monitor.
2. Mark an IN at the head and an OUT halfway through.
3. Cut this portion over to the Record side.
4. Test this portion of the sequence by creating an EDL.

If the EDL generates successfully, you know that the problem is in the second half. If not, subdivide the sequence elsewhere to further isolate the source of the problem.

To subdivide the sequence:

1. Press ⌘-Z to clear the sequence from the Record monitor (so you won't accumulate "Untitled Sequence.01...02...03 etc." in your bin).
2. Load the unsuccessful half into the Source monitor, and repeat steps 2 through 4 in **"Locating Trouble Spots" on page 67**.

Trying One Track at a Time

Another way to isolate trouble spots is to generate an EDL by using one track at a time. The problem might be on a particular track.

For information on isolating tracks, see **"Combining or Isolating Tracks" on page 30**.

Avoiding Problems in EDLs

Several tips may help you resolve problems. You can:

- Simplify effects
- Look for missing information
- Deal with corruptions

Simplifying Effects

You can simplify effects in your sequence that are overly complex. For example, you can remove a color effect from a resized segment. Use comments to help recreate the original sequence in the online suite.

Looking for Missing Information

Occasionally EDL Manager fails to generate a list because clips in the sequence are missing some piece of information essential to the EDL. For example, you try to get an audio list using clips lacking audio timecode.

You can try these suggestions:

- Scan your bins for any obvious omissions of files you need for your sequence.

- Use the slice and dice technique to isolate difficulties.
- In Media Composer, find the overlap frame of troublesome clips, then use the Find Bin command to check their statistics.
- Add information to the bin as needed.

Dealing with Corruptions

List generation may be hampered by *corruptions*. These may be areas where information relating to a clip or transition has become damaged or lost, preventing Media Composer from describing it in an EDL. In extreme cases, corruption prevents the clip from playing. The most effective way of dealing with corruptions is to cut them out and replace them.

Scrupulously backing up a project can reward you if you encounter corruptions. Using an earlier, uncorrupted version of a sequence that doesn't exhibit the corruption can save you considerable time.



APPENDIX A

Check List for Online Editing

When you move from nonlinear to linear editing systems and generate EDLs to help recreate your sequence online, you may encounter some obstacles. If you generate an EDL in a particular format, for example, you might find that this format is incompatible with the edit controller at the online suite. Or, you might be unaware of the dupe reel characteristics you need to specify in the EDL. These problems might result in an unproductive and costly online session.

This appendix contains a check list of procedures and tasks that you can follow to avoid or minimize problems.

Read this check list and follow the suggestions to help eliminate potential problems. If you have any questions, call Avid Customer Support at 800-800-AVID (2843).

1. If possible, bring EDL Manager with you to the online suite, along with the bins on a diskette. You can run EDL Manager on a Macintosh. If you don't have a portable Macintosh, call ahead and find out if you can load EDL Manager from a diskette onto a Macintosh at the suite.
2. Call ahead to the online suite before you finish working offline and find out the following information:

- Ask what kinds of edit controllers are used in the online suite. Find out all of the different types in case you are assigned to one edit controller but end up using another when you get there. If possible, go to the facility and look at the equipment. You can then determine the appropriate EDL format.
- Find out which format of EDL the controller reads. If you're not sure what kind of edit controller is being used, save the EDLs in several different formats. If you're having trouble with one format, you will have other formats to choose from.



CMX 340 is read by most edit controllers.

- Find out if you need to generate a dupe reel list with new timecodes or a multiple B-roll list in EDL Manager. Also, find out if there is any other information required for your project that you should include as a comment in the EDL.
- Find out if the online suite can create all the effects that you specified in your EDL. If not, you may need to regenerate the EDL and adjust the options.
- Check to see if you can send a preliminary version of the EDL ahead of time to see if it loads properly on the edit controller. If it doesn't, you can make the necessary adjustments.
- Find out the name of the switcher in the online suite. If you are not sure which switcher is being used, set the switcher setup in EDL Manager to SMPTE.
- Confirm that the system used in the online suite reads 3 1/4-inch diskettes. Some older systems use only 5 1/2-inch or 8-inch diskettes, and the Macintosh cannot read or write to these types of diskettes.
- Find out whether the edit controller at the site reads high-density or low-density diskettes.

3. When you visit the online suite, you may want to bring the EDLs in several forms:

- Printed on paper (in A-mode sort for easy reference). To print an EDL, choose Print from the File menu while the EDL is displayed in EDL Manager.
- On 3.5-inch diskette.

You may also want to bring as a reference one of the following:

- A digital cut (Media Composer only). For more information see the *Avid Media Composer User's Guide* .
- An audio layback (AudioVision only). For more information see the *Avid AudioVision User's Guide* .
- A printout of the Source Table.



Having your EDLs in several forms allows greater editing flexibility. Also, if there are difficulties, you have a paper copy to refer to.

4. Make sure the EDL filenames are the correct length and type for the diskette format in which you saved them. Follow these guidelines:
   - If you save your EDL to a diskette formatted for CMX or GVG, the file name must have six or fewer upper case alphanumeric characters followed by the extension .EDL. There can be no spaces in the file name, and no characters except letters and numbers.

     For example: TEST1.EDL is a valid file name for GVG and CMX systems.
   - If you save your EDL to a DOS-formatted diskette, make sure the file names are no more than eight alphanumeric characters followed by the .EDL extension. Again, there can be no spaces or other special characters in the file name; only letters and numbers are acceptable.

     For example: WINSTON3.EDL is a valid file name for DOS-formatted diskettes.



APPENDIX B

Creating EDLs for Film Projects

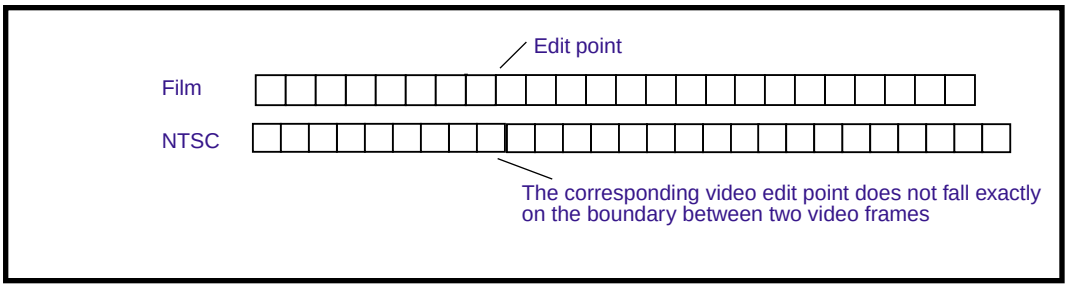
There are several considerations when you create EDLs for film projects. They include:

- **Matchback Conversion in Film-to-Video EDLs**
- **Creating Audio-Only EDLs**

Matchback Conversion in Film-to-Video EDLs

If you are editing a project with a Film Composer system, you may intend to finish the project in video. The *matchback conversion* process requires Film Composer to perform special calculations to match the film to video. Because there is not an even ratio of film-to-video frames, the film and corresponding video edit points do not line up evenly.

For example, with a ratio of 24 film frames to 30 film frames, a 6-frame film edit corresponds exactly to a 7 1/2-frame video edit. However, video edits cannot include partial frames, so the video edit must be 7 or 8 frames long.



Because video edits might be longer or shorter than the original film edits, the system makes sure the film and video sequences match as closely as possible by checking the durations at the end of each edit. If the total video-sequence duration is a frame longer than the film, then the system subtracts a frame from the last video edit. If the video is a frame too short, the system adds a frame to the last video edit.

Creating EDLs for a Matchbacked Sequence

When you create an EDL for a sequence that converts from film to video, an edit the EDL lists might be slightly longer or shorter than the corresponding film edit. The EDL might not be an exact representation of the sequence — it can be plus or minus one frame, in accordance with the 30-to-24 frames per second (fps) matchback conversion. In this case, be aware of the discrepancy when you go to the online suite so that you can adjust for the difference.

Creating Audio-Only EDLs

If you are creating an audio-only EDL for a film project, set the following options in the EDL Manager Options window before generating the list. These options simplify the EDL, and ensure that the pertinent source information is referred from the bin into the EDL.

- Dissolves as Cuts (Optimization area)
- Sound Roll as the Reel ID type (Master List area)
- Sound TC as the Timecode type (Master List area)



APPENDIX C

Transferring EDLs with Serial Transmission

If your offline and online editing suites are in the same building, or if you are transferring the EDL to an edit controller that has no diskette drive, you might need to transmit EDLs from offline to online via serial connections. This appendix explains how to set up the hardware connections between the edit controller and the Macintosh with EDL Manager.

This appendix includes the following sections:

- **Setting up Hardware Connections**
- **Setting Serial Transmission Options**
- **Transmitting the EDL**

Setting up Hardware Connections

Follow these steps to set up hardware connections:

1. Decide which port on the edit controller you want to use for transmission.
2. Find the transmission parameters for the port in the edit controller documentation, then use these parameters to set up hardware options in EDL Manager. Options are:
   - Baud Rate
   - Data Width
   - Stop Bits
   - Parity
   - Handshaking
3. Set up the actual hardware connection between the edit controller and your Macintosh. Typically, you need a cable with an RS 232 or RS 422 connector with 31 pins.

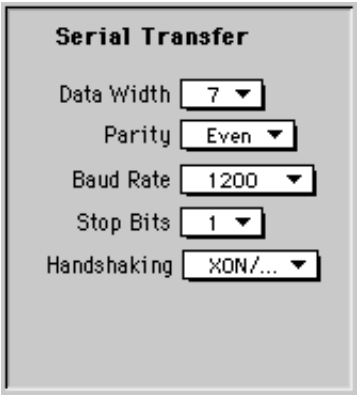
Setting Serial Transmission Options

You need to set up options in EDL Manager so that the two systems can communicate. To set these options:

1. Click the Options button in the EDL Manager main window.

   The Options window appears.

   The Serial Transfer area shows the serial control parameters, which refer to hardware settings.



2. To modify these settings, select an option from the pop-up menu. Table C-1 explains each option.

Table C-1 Serial Control Options

Option	Description
Data Width	Indicates if 7-bit words or 8-bit words are being transferred — the default is 7 bits.
Parity	Indicates error detection, found through counting the number of bits in a transmitted word. *Even* indicates the number of bits in a word is even. *Odd* indicates the number of bits is odd. The default is zero.
Baud Rate	Sets the data transmission rate of the Macintosh that EDL Manager is running on — the default is 9600.
Stop Bits	Indicates how many bits are needed to make a break in transmission — the default is 0 stop bits.
Handshaking	Allows communication between two systems — the default is none. Options include DTR and XON/XOFF.

Once you change these settings and click OK, you are ready to transmit your EDL.

Transmitting the EDL

When you are ready to transmit the EDL, another person should be ready at the edit controller to help.

To transmit the EDL:

1. Click the EDL Manager window to select it.
2. Choose Transmit from the File Menu.

   At the same time the other person presses Receive at the edit controller, you should press Send.

   - If you see events scrolling one by one onto the edit controller screen, the transmission was successful.
   - If you see either an error or strings of indistinguishable text, the serial parameters were set incorrectly in EDL Manager. Check the parameters for the serial port and reset them in the Serial Options window.



Glossary

A/B roll

The use of alternating scenes, recorded on separate source tapes or film rolls, to perform dissolves, wipes, or other types of transitions.

black edits

A video source with no image. A special source you can fade into, out of, or use for other effects.

B-roll

An exact copy of the A-roll original material, or new original material on a separate reel, for use in A/B-roll editing.

CMX

Edit controller made by CMX Corporation (originally a joint venture by CBS and Memorex). CMX uses its own proprietary format EDLs (340, 3600).

conform

To make the final show based on the editing. Conforming organizes the source material for final assembly.

corruptions

Information relating to a clip or transition that has been damaged or lost, preventing EDL Manager from describing the information in an EDL. The solution is to cut the corruptions out and replace them with a backup version of the sequence.

cut

An instantaneous transition from one video source to another. Also, a section of source or record tape.

dissolve

A video or audio transition in which an image from one source gradually becomes less distinct as an image from a second source replaces it.

dupe reel

A reel designated for the recording and playback of dupes (duplicate shots) during videotape editing. You create dupe reels as backup copies, to help in the creation of special effects, and for A/B roll editing.

dupe list

A list of dupe reels.

edit controller

An electronic device, often computer-based, that allows an editor to precisely control, play, and record to various videotape machines. The edit controller keeps track of timecodes for each shot and coordinates the machines in the suite: videotape machines, monitors, an audio mixing board, a videotape switcher, and other peripheral devices.

See also **online suite**.

edit decision list

A list of edits you have made. An edit list can be generated on an Avid Media Composer or another system. You customize and optimize it in the EDL Manager, then take it with the source tapes to an online edit controller for final assembly of your show or program.

event

A number assigned by the editing system to each performed edit. In most computer editing systems, defines an action or a sequence of actions performed by the computer in a single pass of the record tape.

event ID

A unique number the editing system assigns to each performed edit. In most computer editing systems, the event ID defines an action or a sequence of actions the computer performs in a single pass of the record tape.

fade

A dissolve from full video to black video or from full audio to no audio, or vice-versa.

fps

Frames per second, pronounced “fips.”A measure of the film or video display rates.
(NTSC = 30 fps; PAL = 25 fps; SECAM = 25 fps; Film = 24 fps.)

GVG

An edit controller made by Grass Valley Group, using proprietary format EDLs (4.1, 7.0).

handles

Additional source material before and after edit points; you use a handle for later adjustments.

import ID

The internal identification for your Avid source tape.

linear editing

Tape editing in which you assemble the program from beginning to end. If you require changes, you must rerecord everything downstream of the change. The physical nature of the medium (for example, analog videotape) dictates how you must place material on the medium.

master list

A list that specifies the starting event number, reel ID options, and timecode options.

master reel

The tape resulting from editing. The finished program.

matchback conversion

The conversion from film to video frame rates.

NTSC

National Television Standards Committee, the group that established the color television transmission system used in the United States. The standard calls for 525 lines of information scanned at a rate of approximately 30 frames per second.

nonlinear editing

A type of editing in which you do not need to assemble the program from beginning to end. The physical nature of the medium and the technical process of manipulating that medium do not enforce or dictate how the material must be physically ordered. You can use nonlinear editing for traditional film cutting and splicing, and digitized video images. You can make changes at the beginning, middle, or end of the sequence.

offline editing

A nonlinear edit, usually done on a low-cost editing system, using digitized work tapes. This preliminary or rough-cut editing allows you to make edit decisions before performing the final edit.

OMFI

Open Media Framework® Interchange format. A standard format for the interchange of digital media data among heterogeneous platforms. The format is designed to encapsulate all the information required to interchange a variety of digital media, such as audio, video, graphics, and still images as well as the rules for combining and presenting the media. The format includes rules for identifying the original sources of the digital media, and it can encapsulate both compressed and uncompressed digital media data.

online editing

The final editing using the original camera tapes and an edit decision list (EDL) to produce a finished program ready for distribution; usually associated with high-quality computer editing systems. Offline editing often precedes online editing, but in some cases programs go directly to the online editing stage.

See also **edit controller**.

online suite

The site of online editing. A room or rooms containing the edit controller computer, videotape machines, monitors, an audio mixing board, a videotape switcher, and other peripheral devices.

optimization

The process that simplifies your edit decision list. EDL Manager simplifies the text and combines or condenses events to speed up the online assembly process.

overrecord

To use a long shot from one reel, then place shots from other reels over the continuous shot. You can reduce excessive tape shuttling in the online assembly by choosing Allow Overrecords in the Optimization Setup menu. EDL Manager expresses the continuous shots and the shots from other reels chronologically as one event.

PAL

Phase Alternating Line. A color television standard used in many countries. PAL consists of 625 lines scanned at a rate of 25 frames per second.

patching

The routing of audio or video from one channel or track in the sequence to another.

preread

To read information from a tape passing under the play head of a videotape machine before it passes under the record head. Information can be read from the tape before the information is replaced. On digital videotape decks, the information gathered by the play head is stored in a digital buffer; the edit controller can use it as a virtual source, taking the place of a second tape deck in a transition.

reel ID

The reel identification (ID) EDL Manager uses to refer to the master reel source. The reel ID can come from tape, sound roll, camera, or auxiliary sources.

serial control parameters

The options you set to transmit your edit decision list over serial connections to an online edit controller. Options include baud rate, data width, stop bits, parity, and handshaking.

slicing and dicing

Isolating trouble spots in a sequence by repeatedly dividing the sequence in half, creating an EDL for the isolated half, and testing for successful generation.

SMPTE timecode

A frame-numbering system developed by the Society of Motion Picture and Television Engineers and used primarily for electronic editing and timing of video programs. It assigns a number to each frame of video, telling the elapsed number of hours, minutes, seconds, and frames; for example, 01:42:13:26.

See also **timecode**.

sort mode

The mode that controls the auto-assembly process, determining in what order the edit controller reads the edit decision list, and

assembles the final tape. There are six different types of sort mode: A, B, C, D, E, and S.

source table

The list of the source tapes you use to create the sequence the EDL describes. The source table includes three kinds of information: your name for a tape, the Avid name for the same tape, and the Avid internal identification for your Avid source tape.

super

Superimposition. One shot half-dissolved over another.

timecode

An electronic indexing method for editing and timing video programs. Timecode denotes hours, minutes, seconds, and frames (00:00:00:00) elapsed on a videotape.

Address track timecode is recorded simultaneously with the video picture. Longitudinal timecode (LTC) is recorded on an audio track. Vertical interval timecode (VITC) is recorded in the vertical blanking interval of the video track. SMPTE timecode is the prevalent standard.

Other timecodes include film timecode and audio timecode used during film projects. During editing, Media Composer and Film Composer can display and track several types of timecode.

See also **SMPTE timecode**.

track isolation

The process of creating a separate list for each video track to simplify the composition.

wipe

A shaped transition between video sources in which a margin or border moves across the screen, wiping out the image of one scene and replacing it with another.



Index

A B C D E F G H I L M N O P R S T U V W

A

A sort mode 35
Address LTC option 40
All Video selection 30
Audio channels
  mixed down 31
  selecting 28
  supported when reading EDLs 52
Audio EQ info 46
Audio information displayed in EDLs 45
Audio layback 72
Audio-only EDLs for film projects 75
Auxiliary
  reel ID sources 39
  timecode sources 40

B

Bins 39, 60
Black edits, including 48
B-roll 41

C

Changing starting event number 38
Check list for online editing 70 to 72
Checking header format 65
Checking reel names and numbers 64
CMX format 56
Comments 45
Compatibility with other products 9
Console, seeing error messages in 65
Convert to Numbers option 39
Corruptions 69
Creating a sequence from an EDL 62
Creating an EDL
  from a bin 19
  from an OMFI file 21
Creating stereo tracks 31
Customizing EDLs
  in the main window 26
  in the Options window 36

D

Deleting incompatible information 64
Digital cut 72
Dissolve as Cuts option 48
Dupe list setup 41
Dupe reel options 41

E

Edit controllers
- audio tracks, supporting 51
- CMX or GVG format 56
- comments, supporting 46
- EDL options for 26 to 35
- formats 70 to 72
- producing a finished master 18

Editing EDLs with a text editor 64
EDL Manager
- as a standalone application 18, 70
- compatibility with other products 9
- installing 1-13 to 1-15
- serial transmission with 77
- system requirements 1-13

EDLs
- *See also* Saving EDLs
- audio channels in 28 to 32
- creating for film projects 73
- defined 17
- formats supported 32
- online, forms of 71
- options, setting 26 to 51
- serial transmission of 76 to 79
- sort mode 34
- stereo tracks in 31
- video tracks in 28 to 31

Error messages in the Console 65

F

Film, Source In bin 40
Film-to-Video EDLs
- Audio-only 75
- matchback conversion in 73
- matchbacked sequence in 74

Formats 32

G

GVG format 56

H

Handles 44

I

Include Black Edits option 48
Information, missing 68
Installing EDL Manager 1-13 to 1-15

L

Launching EDL Manager 23
List comments 45, 45
Locating trouble spots 67

M

Macintosh diskettes, saving to 58
Macintosh system requirements 1-13
Main window 27
Master list setup 38, 38
Master reel numbers, changing 38
Matchback conversion in EDLs 73
Media Composer sequence, creating 62
Missing information, locating 68
Motion effects, removing 65
Multiple (B-rolls) option (dupe reels) 42
Multiple audio and video tracks 28 to 31

N

Nonlinear editing 19

O

Offline editing 18
OMF, saving EDLs in 59
One, Jam Sync option (dupe reels) 42
One, New Timecodes option (dupe reels) 42
Online editing 18
Online or linear editing 26, 70 to 72
Online suite 18
Optimization 47
Options key 36

P

PAL Film standards 50
Preread
    naming 44
    option for dupe reels 43

R

Reading EDLs
    editing for successful reading into EDL Manager 63
    in CMX/GVG format 56 to 57
    in Macintosh/DOS format 53 to 54
    in OMFI format 54 to 55
Reel IDs 38
Reloading 49
Removing effects 65
Repair notes 47
Resetting EDL options 51
RT11 format 56 to 61

S

Saving EDLs
    in CMX/GVG format 60 to 61
    in Macintosh/DOS formats 58
    in OMF format 59
    verification of RT11 contents 61
Selecting formats 32
Selecting specific video tracks 30
Sequence, creating from an EDL 62
Serial transmission 77
Serial transmission of EDLs 76 to 79
Setting EDL options 26 to 51
Simplifying
    EDLs to read into EDL Manager 63
    events (optimization) 47
Simplifying effects 68
Slicing and dicing 67
Source table 24
Standards 50, 50
Standards setup 50
Starting event number 38
Stereo tracks 31
Successive EDLs for one sequence 30
Switcher standards 50
System requirements 1-13

T

Tape sources 38
Text editor, Vantage 63
Track isolation 30, 30
Track selecting 28, 29
Transferring EDls from Media Composer products 23
Transferring EDLs to a Media Composer product 62
Transitions, fixing 66
Troubleshooting
    corruptions 69

difficult transitions 66
effects 68
error messages in the Console 65
header format 65
problem-causing effects 65
slicing and dicing 67
trouble spots 67

U

Update button 51
Updating EDL options 51

V

Vantage text editor 63
Verifying RT11 disk contents 61
Vertical Interval Timecode (VITC) 40
Video tracks 28 to 31

W

Wipes as Cuts option 48